

Task 13 – Incident Response Plan

Company: Ubuntu Innovations (Pty) Ltd **Prepared by:** Hlumelo **Date:** June 2026

Introduction

This is the incident response plan for Ubuntu Innovations. The main purpose of this document is to make sure that if something goes wrong — a cyberattack, a data breach, malware, anything like that — we have a clear process to follow so we don't just panic and make things worse.

With 25 staff and growing, we're not huge but we're definitely a target. We store client data, financial records, and source code, so getting hit by even a basic attack could cause real damage. Having this plan means we respond fast and in an organised way.

Scope

This plan covers all IT systems at Ubuntu Innovations including:

- Workstations and laptops
 - The file server (FS01)
 - Network infrastructure (router, switches, firewall)
 - Cloud services and company email accounts
 - Any personal devices used to access company systems
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Incident Response Team

These are the people responsible for handling incidents:

Role	Responsibility
IT Support Lead	Overall coordination of the response
IT Support Technician	Technical investigation and containment
Department Manager	Communication with affected department
Executive Manager	Final decisions on escalation or legal action
HR Representative	Handles any incidents involving staff conduct

If we're a smaller team at the time, the IT Support Lead takes on multiple roles where needed.

What Counts as a Security Incident

Not every IT problem is a security incident. But these things definitely are:

- Unauthorised access to systems or accounts
- Ransomware or malware infection
- Suspicious login attempts or account lockouts
- Data being leaked or stolen
- Phishing emails that have been clicked

- Someone sharing credentials or violating access policies
- Unusual network traffic or unexpected outbound connections
- A staff member's device going missing

If you're not sure whether something counts, report it anyway. It's better to investigate something that turns out to be nothing than to ignore something real.

The 6 Phases of Response

Phase 1 – Preparation

Before anything happens, we need to be ready. This includes:

- Keeping this document up to date
- Making sure all staff know how to report an incident
- Keeping system and access logs turned on
- Having offline backups that are tested regularly
- Running security awareness training at least once a year

Phase 2 – Identification

This is when we figure out what's actually happening.

- Who noticed the incident and when?
- What systems are involved?
- Is it still ongoing or has it already happened?
- How serious does it look?

The person who spots the issue must report it immediately to the IT Support Lead. Don't try to fix it yourself first — you might destroy evidence or make it worse.

How to report: Send an email to the IT team or call the IT support line. In the subject line write "SECURITY INCIDENT" so it gets picked up fast.

Incident Severity Levels:

Level	Description	Example
Low	Minor issue, no data at risk	Failed login attempt from outside
Medium	Possible data exposure or system compromise	Malware detected on one workstation
High	Confirmed breach or major disruption	Ransomware spreading across network
Critical	Full system compromise or data leak confirmed	Database exfiltrated, multiple systems down

Phase 3 – Containment

Once we know what we're dealing with, the priority is to stop it spreading.

Short-term containment:

- Disconnect the affected device(s) from the network — unplug the ethernet cable or turn off Wi-Fi
- Do NOT turn the machine off unless instructed — we may lose forensic evidence
- Change passwords for any affected accounts immediately
- Block suspicious IP addresses at the firewall

Long-term containment:

- Set up a clean temporary system for the affected user if needed
- Increase monitoring on similar systems
- Notify department managers of which systems are affected

Phase 4 – Eradication

Getting rid of the actual threat.

- Remove malware using up-to-date antivirus tools
- Delete any files or accounts created by the attacker
- Patch whatever vulnerability was exploited
- Reset credentials for all potentially affected accounts
- Review logs to confirm no backdoors were left behind

Phase 5 – Recovery

Getting things back to normal.

- Restore systems from clean backups (refer to Task 14 – Recovery Plan)
- Reconnect systems to the network one at a time and monitor closely
- Confirm everything is working before declaring the incident closed
- Keep extra monitoring in place for at least 2 weeks after recovery

Phase 6 – Lessons Learned

This part is easy to skip but it's really important.

Within 2 weeks of closing an incident, the IT team must hold a short review meeting to go over:

- What happened and how it was detected
- What we did well and what we could have done faster
- Whether our tools and processes are adequate
- What changes need to be made before the next incident

A written summary must be added to the incident log.

Incident Log

Every incident must be documented, even low-severity ones. The log should include:

- Date and time the incident was reported
- Who reported it
- Systems affected
- Description of what happened
- Actions taken and by whom
- How it was resolved
- Any follow-up required

Keep incident logs in the IT shared folder under `\\FS01\CompanyShare\IT\Documentation` .

Communication Guidelines

- Staff should only be told what they need to know — no mass announcements about incidents unless necessary

- Executives must be informed of any Medium or above incident within 2 hours
 - If client data was compromised, legal advice must be sought before any external communication
 - Do not post anything about security incidents on social media
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After a Critical Incident

If we get hit with a Critical level incident:

1. Inform the executive team immediately
 2. Consider bringing in an external cybersecurity firm
 3. Consult legal counsel regarding breach notification obligations
 4. Preserve all logs and evidence — do not clean up before documentation is done
 5. Review cyber insurance coverage if applicable
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Related Documents

- Task 14 – Disaster Recovery Plan
- Task 15 – Security Awareness Training Outline
- Shared Folder Structure – HLUSTA8
- User and Permissions Matrix – HLUSTA7